

Video Transcript

People with visual impairments may not be able to easily distinguish color differences on digital content with insufficient contrast.

The free desktop application,

“Colour Contrast Analyser” measures color contrast ratios on digital content based on Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG).

Learning to use this important tool will help you create more legible digital content that can be accessed by people of various visual abilities.

To begin, download and open the Colour Contrast Analyser app

Select the Foreground eyedropper tool and hover over and select the foreground or text color.

Next, select the Background eyedropper tool and hover over and select the background color.

The app provides results for the two colors selected in the contrast ratio field

and indicates whether they’re conformant

for regular size text (which is between 12pt and 17 pt for most font types), or large text, which is any text exceeding 18 pt or 14pt bold.

University of California policy requires campuses to meet the WCAG 2.0 AA guidelines.

AA level contrast ratios are 4.5:1 for regular text and 3:1 for large and linked text.

Although it is not required to exceed AA guidelines, you might still want to consider something with higher than minimally-conformant contrast ratios.

This will make your content even more legible and account for contrast degradation that often takes place when exporting content to a video format.

In this example, the color contrast ratio for large text is sufficient, but not for regular size text.

To meet regular text color contrast ratio guidelines,

choose a font text and background combination with

a higher contrast ratio.

In this case, changing

the background color to a darker shade increases the contrast ratios to conformant levels.

Another way to obtain sufficient contrast is to add an outline to the text type (in this

case, a black outline works well).

And remember, this helpful app can be used with many types of digital content,

including webpages, PDFs, Word Documents, as well

as PowerPoint and Google Slide presentations.

For more information on digital accessibility, email allyhelp@berkeley.edu

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